ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 7: **Carrier of Words; Words (poem)** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** essential public services depend on ordinary people's dedication	Thematic argument.
2	**(a)** grow into consequences	Consequence.
3	**(d)** Letters are delivered even in the harshest heat.	Are delivered.
4	**(d)** a metaphor that elevates a routine job	Elevation.
5	**(b)** ethical, urging responsibility	Ethics.
6	**(a)** Neither the heat nor the distance stopped him.	Correct pairing.
7	**(a)** trust is built through consistent service	Trust.
8	**(c)** A gentle word mended what the day had torn.	Healing.
9	**(b)** Carrying a heavy bag	Phrase.
10	**(d)** highlights real need for support and recognition	Balanced.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	One life makes the idea concrete and moving (1) and represents many unseen workers (1).	1+1
12	Khetaram's labour is mostly unseen (1). The writer needs to remind us to respect it (1).	1+1
13	It can show respect or thought (1) and can give space for others (1).	1+1
14	It shows quiet, hard service as essential (1) and deserving honour (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He keeps private news safe (1). He is honest with money (1). He serves without bias (1).	1+1+1
16	His job is ordinary (1). His dedication makes it extraordinary (1). The text shows both (1).	1+1+1
17	Carrying a heavy bag, Khetaram trudged across the sand (1). Participle replaces a clause (1). Same subject (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Plain description without exaggeration (1). Facts of hardship speak for themselves (1). The effect is dignity (1).	1+1+1
18	Words hold power over people (1). Speakers choose to heal or harm (1). Power requires care (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Hardly had he reached the village when it rained (1). Inversion after hardly (1). It adds emphasis (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Khetaram's work (1). The postal service's reach (1). Trust built by service (1). Dignity of labour (1). Larger idea of public duty (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Prose persuades by example (1). Poem by image and advice (1). Different tones (1). Both appeal to values (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Hardworking (1). Honest (1). Humble (1). Representative (1). Impact on the reader (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Poem's idea (1). Khetaram's example (1). Our responsibility (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Saying Khetaram is a postman in a city. He is a **Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS)**, a rural postal worker in the desert region of Rajasthan; do not write 'General Delivery Service'.
- Listing only 'delivering letters' as his work. The chapter also shows him reading letters aloud, because many villagers cannot read, and delivering money orders sent by relatives working far away.
- Giving 'traffic and crowds' as his difficulties. His work is hard because of heat, distance and sand, so use these desert details in the answer.

- Missing the larger point: the postman is a link between remote families and the outside world and carries hope as well as news. The tone of the lesson is respectful and appreciative.
- Mixing the poem with the prose: 'Words' warns that careless words can hurt and advises speaking with care and sincerity. Its mood is thoughtful, not angry.
- Grammar slips: *Khetaram* ***has delivered*** *letters for many years* (present perfect, not 'deliver ... since years'); the opposite of 'trust' is *distrust*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 7: **Carrier of Words; Words (poem)** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** brief, sincere words can carry great meaning	Concision.
2	**(b)** He said that had he known, he would have come earlier.	Unreal past retained.
3	**(c)** it can sustain emotional and economic survival	Implied.
4	**(b)** the quality of the message depends on the carrier and the content	Relation.
5	**(b)** a source of support	Idiom.
6	**(a)** gaps in access to education	Inference.
7	**(b)** Communication is a moral act as well as a practical one	Link.
8	**(d)** a fleeting spoken word	Short-lived.
9	**(c)** confidentiality and fidelity	Ethics.
10	**(b)** Words are harmless	Contradicts the poem.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Few words show restraint (1) which matches its theme of careful speech (1).	1+1
12	Words have power over others (1) so speakers carry responsibility (1).	1+1
13	Built through reliability (1). Risked by access to private news and money (1).	1+1
14	It selects precise images (1) and shows the care it urges (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Dependence shows need (1). It also shows community strength (1). Mutual dependence is the strength (1).	1+1+1
16	Simple words are direct (1). They allow universal reading (1). Complexity lies in implication (1).	1+1+1
17	Words grow into effects (1). Good seeds yield good fruit (1). It urges careful sowing of speech (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Khetaram represents the postal service (1). Individual acts keep the institution alive (1). Public service depends on people (1).	1+1+1
18	Choosing not to speak is a choice (1). Silence prevents harm (1). Poem values restraint (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Chapter: duty of service (1). Poem: duty of speech (1). Both link power with care (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Heat and sand (1). The mailbag (1). Letters read aloud (1). Money orders (1). Result: the value of service becomes visible (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Introduction (1). Problems (1). Suggestions (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Khetaram's example (1). Other workers (1). Why they matter (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening (1). The waiting (1). The letter arrives (1). Reaction (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Saying Khetaram is a postman in a city. He is a **Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS)**, a rural postal worker in the desert region of Rajasthan; do not write 'General Delivery Service'.
- Listing only 'delivering letters' as his work. The chapter also shows him reading letters aloud, because many villagers cannot read, and delivering money orders sent by relatives working far away.
- Giving 'traffic and crowds' as his difficulties. His work is hard because of heat, distance and sand, so use these desert details in the answer.

- Missing the larger point: the postman is a link between remote families and the outside world and carries hope as well as news. The tone of the lesson is respectful and appreciative.
- Mixing the poem with the prose: 'Words' warns that careless words can hurt and advises speaking with care and sincerity. Its mood is thoughtful, not angry.
- Grammar slips: *Khetaram **has delivered** letters for many years* (present perfect, not 'deliver ... since years'); the opposite of 'trust' is *distrust*.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 7: **Carrier of Words; Words (poem)** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** tone is lost, so care is needed	Application.
2	**(b)** keeping private news while helping others read	Dilemma.
3	**(d)** Every letter has a hero	Slogan.
4	**(b)** careless or false words	Contrast.
5	**(a)** the invisibility of essential workers	Social critique.
6	**(b)** faithfulness	Faithfulness.
7	**(c)** Handle Words with Care, and Those Who Carry Them with Respect	Title.
8	**(b)** dismissive language that the chapter challenges	Tone.
9	**(c)** If Khetaram had not come, the family would have waited in vain.	Had + would have.
10	**(d)** words have weight, and so do the people who carry them	Synthesis.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Yes, as hurtful or kind words travel faster online (1) and cannot always be recalled (1).	1+1
12	Remote areas may lack connectivity (1) and personal service adds trust and help for the unlettered (1).	1+1
13	The chapter shows letters carrying news (1). The poem shows words shaping feelings (1).	1+1
14	Reliability and care (1) in carrying or giving words (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It holds messages (1). It is heavy with hope (1). It stands for responsibility (1).	1+1+1
16	If the postman had come, the family would not have worried (1). Third conditional (1). Marks an unreal past (1).	1+1+1
17	A word carries feeling like a letter (1). A kind word reaches the heart (1). It links the two pieces (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It tests endurance (1). It isolates communities (1). It heightens the value of the post (1).	1+1+1
18	Thousands of letters have been delivered by Khetaram (1). Object becomes subject (1). Verb: have been delivered (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Workers make communication possible (1). Words need honest carriers (1). Both deserve respect (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Theme (1). Metaphors (1). Tone of advice (1). Appeal to conscience (1). Relevance today (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Message gives meaning (1). Messenger gives trust (1). Khetaram shows the carrier's role (1). The poem shows the speaker's role (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Instant messages (1). Anonymity (1). Greater reach of words (1). The same need for care (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Words gain weight through trust (1). Khetaram's honesty adds weight (1). The poet urges care in speech (1). Careless carriers lighten words (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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